

PHILOSOPHY

Notable Faculty & Student Achievements

March 2026

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** was invited to speak to the graduate students who are part of the Minorities in Philosophy (MAP) Chapter at Texas State University on February 24. Dr. ka’Nobuhlaluse shared about their research, graduate experiences (in South Africa and the US), and challenges and joys of navigating philosophy as a Black woman.

November 2025

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** had the essay, “An Ode to the Domestic, the Minors of Apartheid, My Grandmother Among Them,” published on the Caribbean Philosophical Association’s blog, *Caliban’s Readings*. It can be read [here](#). The piece is a philosophical and personal meditation on Black women who worked as domestics under Apartheid, with a special focus on ka’Nobuhlaluse’s maternal grandmother. It explores how bureaucracy, racial capitalism, and patriarchal law rendered these women “minors,” even as their labour sustained families, homes, and the nation. Drawing on Black feminist and Africana philosophy, as well as autobiographical writing, ka’Nobuhlaluse thinks through archives not only as formal institutions but as living, intergenerational memory carried in bodies, stories, and ordinary objects. ka’Nobuhlaluse wrote this essay while teaching an FYS on Apartheid.

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** was invited to comment on Hannah Bacon’s paper, “A Critical Phenomenology of Carceral Time,” presented at the 63rd annual Society for Phenomenology Existential Philosophy Conference. This year’s conference was held online over two weekends, October 17–18 and 24–25.

October 2025

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** presented a paper titled “Towards a Black Consciousness like Black Feminist praxis” at the 43rd Annual Spindel Conference, hosted by the Philosophy Department at the University of Memphis from September 25-27. The conference proceedings will be published in a special issue of the *Southern Journal of Philosophy*.

September 2025

Ramphele's essays. The workshop aims to publish contributions into a book anthology that will feature African figures of the 19th and 20th centuries in annotated original documents. The reader aims to contribute to bringing African voices into the global historical perspective and thus stimulate new research.

April 2025

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka'Nobuhlaluse** presented a paper titled "Living In Contemporarity: Towards an afro-fem ethic of sufficiency" and participated in a closed workshop on MJ Alexander's book *Pedagogies of Crossing: Meditations on Feminism, Sexual Politics, Memory, and the Sacred* at the philoSOPHIA Conference held at Texas A&M University in College Station on April 10.

March 2025

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka'Nobuhlaluse** was awarded the Kristeller-Popkin Travel Fellowship worth \$4,000 from the *Journal of the History of Philosophy* for a research project titled "Interrogating Apartheid's Foundations through Alfred Hoernlé's Philosophy." Dr. ka'Nobuhlaluse is one of two awardees to receive the highly competitive grant.

February 2025

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** co-edited, along with Maha Marouan and Alicia Decker, and contributed a critical interview to the piece “In Conversation with Mamphela Ramphele on the Urgency of Storytelling for Blackwomen in South Africa,” in *Writing African Feminist Subjectivities*, the first-ever special issue on African feminism in the history of the journal *Feminist Formations*. This landmark issue, now live on Project MUSE, brings together a powerful collective of feminist scholars, activists, and artists, engaging with African feminist thought in profound and transformative ways. The *Writing African Feminist Subjectivities* issue can be accessed [here](#).

Professor of Philosophy **Michael Bray** discussed the crisis of democracy and populist politics as the guest for an episode of the limited podcast series *Crisis Point*, run by the Sheffield Political Economy Research Institute (SPERI) at the University of Sheffield, England. The series will air in March.

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** presented at the first annual conference of the League of African Women Philosophers (LAWP) held virtually on January 25–26. The title of their paper was “Reading Makhoere’s Autobiography of Prison Under Apartheid South Africa via an ‘Existential Standpoint.’” The League of African Women Philosophers is important because it represents a vital step toward addressing the historical underrepresentation of African women in philosophy and the broader intellectual discourse.

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse**’s book review on *Simone de Beauvoir and the Colonial Experience: Freedom, Violence, and Identity* by Nathalie Nya was published online under “Volume 34 (2023): Issue 2 (December 2024): Special Issue: Sites of Coercion: Plantation, Colony, Metropole,” edited by Janine Jones, in *Simone de Beauvoir Studies*. In the review, Dr. ka’Nobuhlaluse unpacks Nya’s compelling arguments and discusses how this book challenges us to rethink Beauvoir’s relevance in today’s global struggles for liberation and justice. The review also critiques the use of phrases such as “non-white” within European and American scholarship by drawing attention to the problematic uses as seen in Apartheid South Africa. It can be read [here](#).

November 2024

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** had a piece in public philosophy, titled “A Clothing Paradox Unbuttoned: Why We Should All Be Ethical Shoppers,” published in the Blog

with the pressing need for sustainability and justice in global supply chains? This essay is part of a larger work on thinking about an eco-feminist praxis. The article can be accessed [here](#).

September 2024

Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Zinhle ka’Nobuhlaluse** virtually presented a working draft of a book chapter titled “The Interlocking Nature of Apartheid Praxis” at a workshop on “Apartheid as Method for Worldmaking after Empire: Encountering histories, presents, and continuities of Apartheid in South Africa,” held at the University of the Witwatersrand on September 17. The workshop aims to provide authors with feedback towards an edited volume on Critical Apartheid Studies.

January 2024

Visiting Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Gwen Daug**s presented a paper at the 2024 Eastern Division meeting of the American Philosophical Association titled “Moral Panic and Gender: Michel Foucault, Toby Beauchamp, and the Safety of Children.”

August 2023

Professor of Philosophy **Michael Bray** published an essay, "Ernesto Laclau and Chantal Mouffe's Post-Marxism Can't Give Us a Political Strategy," on the Jacobin website. A Spanish translation, "Laclau, Mouffe y la estrategia política," was also published on Jacobinlat.com.

July 2023

In July, Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Jorge Lizarzaburu** presented the paper "An Extended Evolutionary Account of Human Nature" at the International Society for the History Philosophy and Social Studies of Biology at the University of Toronto.

May 2023

The following individuals were recently recognized as award recipients for the 2022-23 academic year. Teaching awards: Visiting Assistant Professor of Chemistry **Chelsea Massaro**, Assistant Professor of Philosophy **Jorge Lizarzaburu**, and Associate Professor of French **Francis Mathieu**.

April 2022

Lurlyn and Durwood Fleming Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** has completed a second 10-month contract with the Austin Police Department (APD), this time to develop guidelines and formal procedures for selecting and reviewing video training material for the Cadet Academy that focus on recognizing and addressing the ways video material can have unintended consequences and harms and may reinforce rather than disrupt larger cultural narratives and stereotypes. Hopkins has written and submitted a final report to APD and the Austin City Council. He remains under contract for the remainder of this year on the larger curriculum review committee whose task is to review and develop improved training curricula and content across the several training regimes for APD. This work was recently featured in a *60 Minutes* episode that noted its innovative (and largely unprecedented) approach but not the many and various difficulties it faces among entrenched institutional histories and competing political agendas.

January 2021

Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** has completed an eight-month process as part of a community panel reviewing materials used at the Austin Police Department (APD) Training Academy. The panel was the longest-serving component of the Austin City Council's Resolution 66 (December 2019), which initiated an investigation into bias and racism in the APD. The final

August 2020

Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** was a panelist for “Trauma and Policing: An Abusive Relationship,” part four of the Austin Justice Coalition conversation series *Imagining a World without Police*, on August 5.

July 2020

Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** was a panelist in a two-part Zoom town hall meeting on policing and Arab, Muslim, and Middle Eastern communities. The event was hosted by Interconnecting Arabs, Muslims, and Middle Easterners (I-AMM) on July 18 and 25.

perception and prescriptions for disrupting racialized perceptions to try to understand persistent police violence against people of color and in general. He will also be a panelist on July 15 during a webinar for the National Association of Social Workers on policing practices, particularly during the coronavirus pandemic.

June 2020

Professor of Philosophy **Michael Bray**'s article "The Virus Infects Politics: Six Theses on Social Reproduction, Biopolitical Economies, and the Legitimacy of States," appeared online in two parts in the new journal *Spectre*. Read it here: [Part 1](#), [Part 2](#).

May 2020

Professor of Philosophy **Phil Hopkins** was selected to serve as an outside consultant on the training audit review panel as part of the Austin Police Department (APD) evaluation mandated by recent Austin City Council Resolution 66, which set up an investigation into bias and bigotry within the APD.

[Menu](#) [Search](#)

[Apply](#) [Visit](#) [Majors & Minors](#)

GEORGETOWN, TEXAS

512.863.6511

[CONTACT](#)